

Storage is no longer about boring boxes. There's style as well as performance. We've tested a whole range of external storage solutions this month

Appetite for consumption



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One are the days when external memory devices were boring to look at. They've now become a lifestyle product of sorts with companies trying to outdo each other not only in increased capacity, but also improved aesthetics. Portable drives are getting more compact and sleek as compared

to their previous generation counterparts. Form factors are also reducing with the passing of time. The comparatively bulkier desktop hard drives are now available in stylish rectangular cases.

With digital data encompassing all aspects of our life, the need for storage other than the static internal hard drive has risen. With memory becoming cheaper as time passes, the storage capacity has improved by leaps and

bounds. Not only does it improve portability, it also makes a lot of economical sense to have some sort of external hard drive for purposes like backing up important data.

Portable hard drives

Unlike internal storage devices, with portable hard drives even form factor and design aspects matter. This segment comprised compact, sleek and stylish hard drives that provide portability which is very important for indi-

viduals with heavy data storage requirements. With more and more people archiving their files digitally be it music, documents, photographs or videos, the market for external hard drives will always be on the rise. None of the portable hard drives required any external power connection.

We got around nine compact drives to test in this category. Western Digital's (WD) Passport series of external hard drives all have a similar design. We tested